



Setting up e-invoicing

Eight steps in two parts. Part A is done once, by whoever runs the server. Part B is done by every business that wants to file e-invoices, in their own account.

Steps 1–4 platform operator, once **5–8** every business, on their own

CONTENTS

Set up once — platform operator

- 1 Register for API access, on the sandbox first
- 2 Copy the portal's public key
- 3 Add four settings to Render
- 4 Confirm the server picked it up

Every business, on their own

- 5 Enter your portal credentials
- 6 Test the connection
- 7 Switch reporting on, and try one invoice
- 8 Move to production

A Set up once — platform operator

1

Register for API access, on the sandbox first

- 1 Go to einv-apisandbox.nic.in — the free testing environment. Do the whole setup here before touching production.
- 2 Find **Registration** (sometimes under "API Registration" or "Sign Up").
- 3 Register using your business's **GSTIN** — the one you will file e-invoices for. You will verify it with an OTP to the mobile or email already registered against that GSTIN on the GST portal.
- 4 The portal issues four things. Save all four somewhere safe:
 - A **Client ID**
 - A **Client Secret**
 - An **API username**, for that GSTIN
 - An **API password**, for that GSTIN

CAREFUL

The username and password belong to **one business**, not to the platform. Do not put them in Render — every tenant enters their own under Business Profile → E-Invoicing, later in this guide. Only the Client ID and Client Secret are shared across all tenants.

2

Copy the portal's public key

- 1 On the same developer portal, open **Authentication** or **API Overview**.
- 2 Find the public key — a block of text between `-----BEGIN PUBLIC KEY-----` and `-----END PUBLIC KEY-----`, or a downloadable `.pem` file.
- 3 Copy the whole thing, including the BEGIN/END lines.

WHY IT MATTERS

Copy it exactly — don't retype it, don't reformat it. This key encrypts every tenant's password before it leaves the server, and one changed character makes every authentication fail with the same unhelpful error.

3

Add four settings to Render

Open Render → your backend service → the **Environment** tab, and add:

KEY	VALUE
IRP_BASE_URL	https://einv-apisandbox.nic.in to start
IRP_CLIENT_ID	from Step 1
IRP_CLIENT_SECRET	from Step 1
IRP_PUBLIC_KEY	the whole block from Step 2

Press **Save Changes**. Render redeploys the backend automatically — wait for that to finish before moving on.

TIP

If Render's box will not accept the public key as multi-line text, either replace each real line break with `\n` and paste it as one line, or base64-encode the whole .pem file and paste that instead — the server accepts both. Try pasting it as-is first; it often just works.

4

Confirm the server picked it up

Once redeployed, sign in as an admin and open **Business Profile** → **E-Invoicing**.

If the four settings were read correctly, the warning *"E-invoicing is not switched on for this server yet"* is gone. If it is still there, it names exactly which of the four is still missing.

5

Enter your portal credentials

- 1 Open **Business Profile** → **E-Invoicing**.
- 2 Enter your **GSTIN**, **API username** and **API password** — the ones issued to your business in Step 1.
- 3 Leave **Portal** set to **Sandbox** for now.
- 4 Press **Save e-invoicing settings**.

TIP These are not your login for the app, and not your login for the GST portal — they are the separate API credentials the e-invoice portal issued when you registered.

6

Test the connection

- 1 Press **Test connection**.
- 2 It should say *"Connected to the sandbox e-invoice portal as ..."*.

If it fails instead, the message names which credential was refused — the username, the password, or the GSTIN not matching the account.

WHY IT MATTERS This only checks that your details are correct. It does not report anything to the government — nothing is filed by pressing this button.

7

Switch reporting on, and try one invoice

- 1 Turn on **Report invoices to the portal** and save again.
- 2 Raise an invoice for a customer who has a GSTIN — e-invoicing only applies to business customers, not walk-in retail sales.
- 3 Open it and press **Generate IRN**.
- 4 Check the invoice number, the IRN and a signed QR code now appear on the document.

8

Move to production

Only once Step 7 has genuinely worked. Production is a separate account from sandbox — nothing carries over automatically.

- 1 Repeat Step 1 on the real portal (einvoice1.gst.gov.in) to get a **production** Client ID and Secret.
- 2 *Platform operator:* update `IRP_BASE_URL` , `IRP_CLIENT_ID` , `IRP_CLIENT_SECRET` and `IRP_PUBLIC_KEY` in Render to the production values — the production public key is different from the sandbox one.
- 3 *Each tenant:* switch **Portal** from Sandbox to Production, and enter the production API password issued for that GSTIN.

CAREFUL

Don't skip the sandbox step to save time. It costs nothing, touches no real GST return, and is the only way to catch a wrong credential before it matters on a document that actually gets filed.

If something does not connect

Test connection fails with the portal's own words — it names whether the username, the password or the GSTIN was the problem, rather than a generic error.

If the whole card is missing from Business Profile, e-invoicing is either not on this business's plan, or Part A has not been completed on the server yet — check with whoever administers the platform.